

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 7 2  
 ♥ K 9 6 4  
 ♦ 9 2  
 ♣ K 7 6 3

♠ A Q J 10 9 8

♥ A Q J

♦ 8 4

♣ A Q



♠ 6 5  
 ♥ 10 8 3  
 ♦ K Q J 10 7  
 ♣ 8 4 2

♠ 4 3

♥ 7 5 2

♦ A 6 5 3

♣ J 10 9 5

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          | 2♣    | Pass | 2♦    |
| Pass     | 2♠    | Pass | 2NT   |
| Pass     | 4♠    |      |       |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

4♠ by North

surely still have a ♥ loser. But if you finesse the ♣K successfully you will eliminate your ♣ loser.

North is to play 4♠. East leads the ♦K.

Losers: ♠=1 ♥=1 ♦=1 ♣=1 Total = 4

East has made another great lead. Any other suit would have given you a free finesse. You should duck the first ♦. It is very possible that East has led from ♦K Q 10 and will be afraid to continue for fear you have the ♦J in your hand. You'd be very happy to see him switch to any other suit. But he doesn't, he continues with the ♦Q which you take with dummy's ♦A.

You are in dummy for the first, last, and only time. You need to try a finesse right now, but which one? At first you might think it makes no difference but, in fact, there is only one reasonable choice. If you finesse the ♠K successfully you may still have a ♠ loser. If you finesse the ♥K successfully you will

What a great layout! Three possible finesses and every one of them would work.

But as you can see, only the ♣ finesse will actually save you a trick.

**Board 3**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 2  
 ♥ K Q J 5 2  
 ♦ Q 10 8  
 ♣ 9 4 3

♠ A 8 7 3

♥ 9 6

♦ 7 6 3

♣ A Q J 10



♠ -

♥ 10 8 7 3

♦ K J 9 4

♣ K 8 6 5 2

♠ K Q J 9 6 5 4

♥ A 4

♦ A 5 2

♣ 7

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          |       |      | 1 ♠   |
| Pass     | 3 ♠   | Pass | 4NT   |
| Pass     | 5 ♥   | Pass | 6 ♠   |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

6 ♠ by South

♥ loser. West may be able to win the trick but you can ruff a ♥ return, and dummy will have two good ♣s on which you can discard 2 ♦ losers.

South is to play 6 ♠. West leads the ♥K.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=1 ♦=2 ♣=0 Total = 3

Your only hope for ridding yourself of two of those losers is dummy's ♣ suit. One possibility would be to finesse West for the ♣K, and if that works, discard your ♥ loser on the ♣A. You could then establish another ♣ winner for one of the ♦ losers. The problem with that plan is that if the finesse fails the defense will immediately take the setting ♥ trick.

A better plan is a ruffing finesse. Win the first trick with your ♥A and pull trumps with your ♠ K Q.

Next play your ♣7 to dummy's ♣A. Then lead the ♣Q from dummy. If East plays the ♣K you will ruff, enter dummy, and discard two red losers on the ♣ J 10. If East plays low instead, you discard your

Ruffing finesses sometimes provide you the best opportunity, like this time.

But they are easy to overlook, mainly because we don't use them often.

**Board 5**

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 8 7 6

♥ 8 6 4 2

♦ 8 2

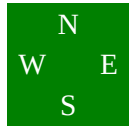
♣ 10 7 3

♠ A Q 5

♥ K J 9

♦ A 10 4

♣ Q J 9 2



♠ K J 3

♥ Q 7 3

♦ K Q J 9 5

♣ 8 4

♠ 9 4 2

♥ A 10 5

♦ 7 6 3

♣ A K 6 5

*West*

*North*

*East*

*South*

1 ♦

Pass

1NT

Pass

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North